

NovaLink R500

Wireless Dual-Band Router

USER MANUAL

Model: NL-R500-AC1200

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1. Package Contents

Your NovaLink R500 package includes the following items:

- NovaLink R500 Wireless Router
- 12V / 1.5A Power Adapter
- 1 x Ethernet (RJ45) Cable, 1 meter
- Quick Start Guide
- Wall-mount screws and anchors

2. Product Overview and LED Indicators

The NovaLink R500 is a dual-band AC1200 wireless router supporting simultaneous 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz connections. The front panel contains six status LEDs and the rear panel contains four Ethernet LAN ports, one WAN (Internet) port, a power port, a Power switch, and a recessed Reset button.

LED	Color / State	Meaning
Power	Solid Green	Router is powered on and functioning normally
Power	Blinking Green	Router is starting up (boot sequence in progress)
Internet (WAN)	Solid Green	Internet connection is active
Internet (WAN)	Blinking Orange	No internet signal / cable unplugged
Internet (WAN)	Off	WAN port not connected
2.4 GHz Wi-Fi	Solid Blue	2.4 GHz wireless is broadcasting
5 GHz Wi-Fi	Solid Purple	5 GHz wireless is broadcasting
LAN 1-4	Solid Green	A device is connected to that LAN port

3. Getting Started - Turning the Router On

Follow these steps to power on your NovaLink R500 for the first time:

- 1 Place the router in an open, central location, away from walls and metal objects, for best wireless coverage.
- 2 Connect the supplied Ethernet cable from your modem (or ONT) to the WAN port on the router, labeled "Internet".
- 3 Connect the power adapter to the router's power port and plug the other end into a wall outlet.
- 4 Locate the Power switch on the rear panel and move it to the ON (I) position.
- 5 Wait 60-90 seconds while the router boots up. The Power LED will blink green during startup and turn solid green once the router is fully on.
- 6 Once the Power LED is solid green and the Internet LED turns solid green, the router is online and ready to use.

Note: If the Power LED does not light up at all, verify the power adapter is firmly seated and the wall outlet is supplying power. Do not use a power adapter from a different router model, as this may damage the unit.

4. Initial Setup and Wi-Fi Configuration

1. On a laptop or phone, open the Wi-Fi settings and connect to the default network printed on the label at the bottom of the router (format: NovaLink-R500-XXXX).
2. Open a web browser and go to <http://192.168.1.1> or <http://novalink.setup>.
3. Log in with the default credentials: username **admin**, password **admin**.
4. Follow the on-screen Setup Wizard to configure your Wi-Fi network name (SSID) and password.
5. Click "Apply" and wait for the router to reboot automatically to apply settings.

Important: Change the default admin password immediately after setup to prevent unauthorized access to your router's configuration panel.

5. Restarting the Router

Restarting (rebooting) the router power-cycles the device without erasing any saved settings such as your Wi-Fi name, password, or port forwarding rules. This is the recommended first step for resolving "internet is down", slow speeds, or devices unable to connect.

Method 1: Power Switch (Recommended)

- 1 Move the Power switch on the rear panel to OFF and wait 10 seconds.
- 2 Move the Power switch back to ON.
- 3 Wait 60-90 seconds for the Power LED to turn solid green and the Internet LED to reconnect.

Method 2: Admin Panel

1. Log in to <http://192.168.1.1>.
2. Navigate to Administration > Reboot.
3. Click "Reboot Router" and confirm. The router will restart automatically.

Method 3: Remote / Support-Assisted Restart

Support agents (human or automated) can trigger a remote restart using the router's unique serial number, found on the bottom label (format: NL500-XXXXXXX) or in the Admin Panel under Status > Device Information. A remote restart takes 60-90 seconds and does not erase configuration.

Do not unplug the power cable directly as an alternative to the Power switch; always prefer a graceful restart to avoid firmware corruption.

6. Resetting the Router (Factory Reset)

A factory reset erases ALL custom settings, including your Wi-Fi name, password, and any port forwarding or parental control rules, and restores the router to its original factory defaults. Only perform a factory reset if a restart does not resolve the issue, or if you are preparing the router for resale.

- 1 Ensure the router is powered on.
- 2 Locate the small, recessed Reset button on the rear panel (next to the LAN ports).
- 3 Using a paperclip or pin, press and hold the Reset button for 10 seconds.
- 4 Release the button once all LEDs flash simultaneously. The router will reboot with factory default settings.
- 5 Reconnect using the default network name and password printed on the bottom label, then repeat the Initial Setup steps in Section 4.

7. Troubleshooting - Internet / Connectivity Issues

Symptom	Likely Cause	Recommended Action
Internet LED is off	WAN cable unplugged or modem is down	Check cable connections; verify modem is powered on
Internet LED blinking orange	No signal from ISP	Restart the router (Section 5); contact ISP if issue persists
"Internet is down" / no devices can browse	Temporary WAN glitch or router needs refresh	Restart the router; this resolves the majority of connectivity drops
Internet works on some devices but not others	Device-specific Wi-Fi or DNS issue	Restart the affected device's Wi-Fi; if isolated to one device, router reset
Intermittent disconnects every few minutes	Overheating or channel interference	Ensure ventilation; restart router; consider changing Wi-Fi channel

8. Troubleshooting - Wi-Fi Issues

- Cannot see the network in Wi-Fi list: Confirm the router is powered on and the 2.4 GHz / 5 GHz LEDs are lit; move closer to the router.
- Wrong password error: Passwords are case-sensitive; confirm Caps Lock is off. If forgotten, log in to the Admin Panel via an Ethernet-connected device to view or reset it.
- Slow Wi-Fi speeds: Too many devices on one band, physical obstructions, or interference from neighboring networks. Try switching devices to the 5 GHz band for higher speed at shorter range.
- Wi-Fi drops but Internet LED stays green: This indicates a wireless-only issue; a restart (Section 5) typically resolves it without needing a factory reset.

9. Changing the Wi-Fi Password

1. Connect to the router and log in to <http://192.168.1.1>.
2. Go to Wireless > Wireless Settings.
3. Enter a new password (WPA2/WPA3, minimum 8 characters) in the Password field.
4. Click Save. Connected devices will briefly disconnect and must reconnect using the new password.

10. Firmware Updates

1. Log in to <http://192.168.1.1>.
2. Go to Administration > Firmware Update.
3. Click "Check for Updates". If a new version is available, click "Update Now".
4. Do not power off the router during an update. The process takes 2-5 minutes and the router will restart automatically when complete.

Interrupting a firmware update may permanently damage the router. Ensure a stable power supply before starting an update.

11. Technical Specifications

Specification	Details
Model Number	NL-R500-AC1200
Wireless Standard	IEEE 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac
Frequency Bands	2.4 GHz (up to 300 Mbps) + 5 GHz (up to 867 Mbps)
Ethernet Ports	4 x LAN (10/100/1000 Mbps), 1 x WAN (10/100/1000 Mbps)
Antennas	4 x fixed external antennas
Power Input	12V DC / 1.5A
Operating Temperature	0 degC to 40 degC
Dimensions	180 mm x 125 mm x 32 mm
Default IP Address	192.168.1.1
Default Admin Credentials	Username: admin / Password: admin
Serial Number Location	Bottom label, format NL500-XXXXXXXX

12. Safety Information

- Use only the power adapter supplied with the router.
- Do not expose the router to water, excessive heat, or direct sunlight.
- Ensure adequate ventilation; do not stack objects on top of the router.
- Disconnect the power adapter during electrical storms or extended periods of disuse.
- There are no user-serviceable parts inside; do not open the router casing.

13. Warranty and Support Contact

The NovaLink R500 is covered by a 2-year limited hardware warranty from the date of purchase. For assistance with setup, troubleshooting, restarts, or warranty claims, contact NovaLink Support:

Channel	Details
Support Portal	support.novalinknetworks.example
Email	support@novalinknetworks.example
Phone (India)	1800-000-5001 (Toll Free, 9 AM - 9 PM IST)
Live Chat	Available on the Support Portal, 24x7

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